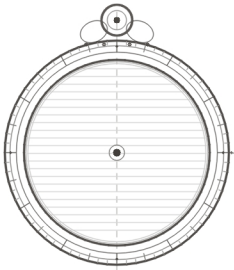
Anatomy of the Artifact

I. The Mater (The Mother)

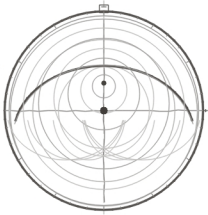
Heavy outer bronze casing
holding internal plates.
Limbus divided into 24 hours
and 360 angular degrees.
Recessed bed prevents warping.



The Mater: 360° limbus & base frame

II. The Tympan (Horizon Plate)

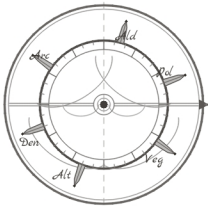
Exchangeable disc engraved for
Latitude 38° 12 (Sanctuary Datum).
Stereographic curves show altitude
circles converging at the zenith.



The Tympan: Almucantars for Lat. 38° 12

III. The Rete (The Star Web)

Openwork bronze skeleton of sky.
Concentric ring traces the zodiac.
Flame pointers mark guide stars.



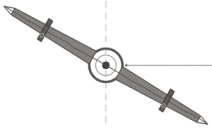
The Rete: Ecliptic band & 6 star pointers

The 6 Star Pointers
1. Ald – Aldebaran (Taurus)
2. Pol – Polaris (Ursa Minor)
3. Veg – Vega (Lyra)
4. Alt – Altair (Aquila)
5. Den – Deneb (Cygnus)
6. Arc – Arcturus (Bootes)

Flame tips indicate sidereal hours on limbus

IV. The Alidade (Sight Rule)

Revolving sighting ruler on back.
Dual pinholes measure star altitude.



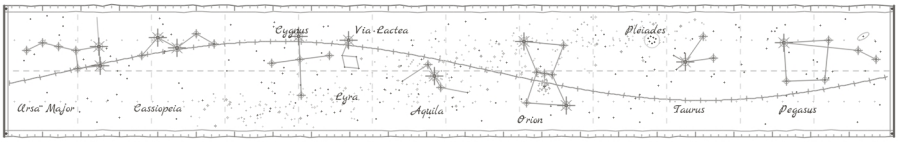
The Alidade: Elevation sighting ruler

V. The Horse Wedge (Equus)

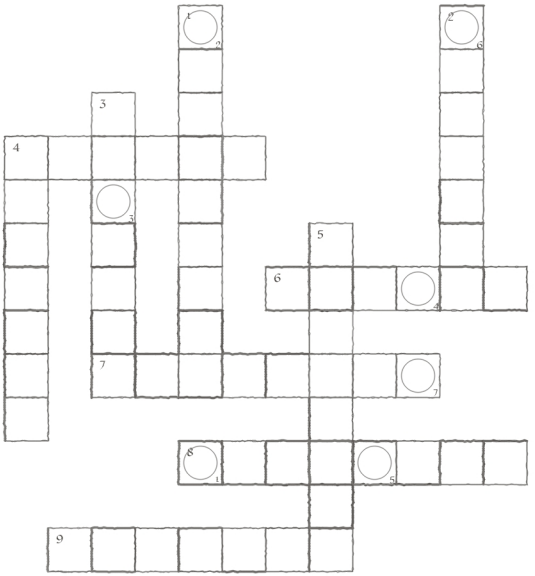
Traditional locking wedge holding plates.
Slips out instantly to swap horizons.

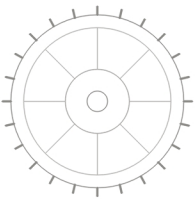


The Horse Wedge: Locks central axis pin



The Zodiacal Engine





Across (The Horizontal Circles)

4. The point where a wandering star or moon is farthest from Earth.

6. The highest point of the celestial dome, directly overhead.

7. The longest noon, when the sun reaches northernmost declination.

8. The great golden track traced by the sun through the twelve houses.

9. The boundless ring where earth meets the dome of heaven.

Down (The Vertical Planes)

1. Of the heavenly sphere and its ancient revolving harmonies.

2. The brass arc used to measure the angular height of the stars.

3. The northern pivot of heaven, steady guide of nocturnal mariners.

4. The revolving sight rule that aligns with distant beacons.

5. The great noon circle passing through observer and both poles.

The Master Key (Assemble the seven numbered circles 1 to 7):

1 2 3 4 5 6 7